
EXPERIENCE

Palo Alto Networks

Jan 2020 — Current

Principal Security Consultant / Extended Expertise

Remote

- Security Transformation and Recovery: Lead the design and deployment of Palo Alto Networks security solutions to drive rapid security transformation for enterprise customers migrating to the cloud.
- Infrastructure as Code (IaC): Architect and deploy scalable security infrastructure using IaC across GCP, OCI, AWS, and Azure, ensuring that recovery environments adhere to Palo Alto Networks reference architectures and industry best practices.
- Trusted Advisory: Act as a primary technical advisor to customer account teams and stakeholders, identifying critical policy and technology gaps that enabled security breaches and developing holistic remediation plans.
- Cross-Functional Collaboration: Collaborate with internal engagement leads and diverse customer contacts, from technical admins to executive leadership, to communicate project status, mitigate risks, and ensure a cohesive post-incident security posture.
- High-Pressure Execution: Manage complex configuration and troubleshooting tasks in high-stakes environments, remaining composed and articulate while guiding customers through urgent security improvements.
- Agile Leadership: Designate and guide Agile processes for engineering teams to accelerate the delivery of secure, cloud-native infrastructure and mission-critical updates.

University of Colorado - Denver

Sep 2025 — Current

Faculty Lecturer

Denver, CO

- Guiding students through fundamental concepts of IT infrastructure, data management, and the role of information systems in modern business and technology.

Salesforce

Oct 2014 — Jan 2020

Security Engineer

Bellevue, Washington

- Security Engineer with the Detection and Response Engineering team at Salesforce. My team is based primarily in Bellevue, Washington. I've been working remotely on this team from another part of the US for approximately three years.
- My team collects security data and logs from many sources, then normalizes and runs data science models on them to find bad actors in a way that enhances and extends traditional human-based Detection and Response work. My job in particular is to create the automation and pipelines to gather this data, which is often referred to as #dataengineering. I also work on the CI/CD pipeline and automation of unit and integration testing for tools our broader team has spread across many Git repositories.

Principal Research Software Engineer

Aug 2012 — Jan 2014

Security Engineer

Indiana University, Bloomington IN

- Test Architect in Software Defined Networking Lab, designed test cases and direct test efforts on openflow networks.
- Wrote web based tools for GENI/GEMINI project. Assistant instructor for undergraduate networking (lead discussions, create and grade homework, and proctor exams).
- Research very high capacity storage solutions and high speed network connections.

Nokia Siemens Networks

Apr 2011 — Jul 2012

Research And Development Engineer

Espoo, Uusimaa, Finland and Arlington Heights, IL USA

- CDMA Cellular base station product development.

Motorola - Cellular Networks and Space Sector

Jan 1998 — Mar 2011

Senior Software Engineer

Arlington Heights, IL

- Worked on and with customer accounts teams including Sprint, ALLTEL, Lucent, Pelephone, NTT, etc.
- Systems Integration and Test (part of various feature teams, product dev)
- CDMA base station development (C/C++)

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Franklin Diaz

Security Consultant

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science , <i>Roosevelt University</i>	2002
Master of Science in Information Systems , <i>Northwestern University</i>	2004
Master of Science in Computer Security , <i>DePaul University</i>	2007

PROJECTS

Stash House — What to do about your issue of a "dirty" local development environment.	Current Project
Cloud Lab — A Cloud Native Security Lab in Google Cloud	January 29, 2022
the greebling — Generating Minecraft schematics with AI Edge TPU hardware	Current Project